

# SMARTPHONE MADE EASY

A Large Print Guide  
for Ages 45+

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Step-by-Step Instructions for iPhone & Android

Big Text | Clear Steps | Easy to Follow

By

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## **Smartphone Made Easy - A Large Print Guide for Ages 45+**

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# Lesson 1: Setting Up Your Phone

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Step 1: Press and hold the power button on the side until the screen lights up.

Step 2: Choose your language (usually English) and tap Next or Continue.

Step 3: Connect to your home WiFi by selecting your network name and typing the password.

Step 4: Sign in with your Apple ID (iPhone) or Google account (Android), or create one.

Step 5: Set a passcode or PIN to keep your phone secure - choose something you will remember.

Step 6: Choose your preferences for location, Siri/Google Assistant, and notifications.

Step 7: Your phone is ready! Take a moment to look at the home screen icons.

## Lesson 2: Making Phone Calls

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Step 1: Find the green Phone icon on your home screen and tap it once.

Step 2: You will see a keypad with numbers. Tap the numbers of the phone number.

Step 3: Press the green call button at the bottom to start the call.

Step 4: Hold the phone to your ear or tap the speaker icon for speakerphone.

Step 5: When finished, tap the red End Call button to hang up.

Step 6: To call someone in your contacts, tap Contacts and find their name.

Step 7: To redial someone, tap the Recents tab to see your call history.

## Lesson 3: Sending Text Messages

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Step 1: Find the Messages icon (green with a white speech bubble) and tap it.

Step 2: Tap the compose button (usually a pencil or plus sign) for a new message.

Step 3: Type the person's name or phone number in the To field at the top.

Step 4: Tap the text box at the bottom where it says 'Type a message'.

Step 5: Use the on-screen keyboard to type your message.

Step 6: Press the send button (arrow icon) when your message is ready.

Step 7: Their reply will appear in the same conversation below your message.

## Lesson 4: Taking Photos

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Step 1: Find the Camera app icon and tap it to open the camera.

Step 2: Point your phone at what you want to photograph.

Step 3: Hold the phone steady with both hands for a clear picture.

Step 4: Tap the large circle button at the bottom to take the photo.

Step 5: View your photo by tapping the small preview in the corner.

Step 6: To switch to the front camera for selfies, tap the rotate camera icon.

Step 7: All photos are saved automatically in your Photos or Gallery app.

## Lesson 5: Using WiFi

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Step 1: Open Settings (the gear icon) on your phone.

Step 2: Tap WiFi or Wireless & Networks.

Step 3: Make sure WiFi is turned ON (toggle should be green or blue).

Step 4: You will see a list of available networks. Find your home network name.

Step 5: Tap your network name and enter your WiFi password carefully.

Step 6: Once connected, you will see a checkmark or the WiFi symbol at the top.

Step 7: Your phone will remember this network and connect automatically next time.

## Lesson 6: Downloading Apps

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Step 1: Open the App Store (iPhone) or Google Play Store (Android).

Step 2: Tap the Search bar at the top or bottom of the screen.

Step 3: Type the name of the app you want to download.

Step 4: Find the correct app in the results and tap on it.

Step 5: Tap 'Get' or 'Install' to download the app to your phone.

Step 6: You may need to confirm with your password or fingerprint.

Step 7: The app will appear on your home screen when the download finishes.



## Lesson 7: Using Email on Your Phone

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Step 1: Open the Mail or Gmail app (it looks like an envelope).

Step 2: Sign in with your email address and password if prompted.

Step 3: Your inbox shows all received emails - newest at the top.

Step 4: Tap any email to open and read it.

Step 5: To write a new email, tap the compose button (pencil or plus icon).

Step 6: Enter the recipient's email, type a subject line, then write your message.

Step 7: Tap Send (paper airplane icon) when your email is ready to go.

## Lesson 8: Video Calls (FaceTime & Zoom)

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Step 1: For FaceTime (iPhone): Open FaceTime app and tap the person's name.

Step 2: Tap the video camera icon to start a video call.

Step 3: For Zoom: Download the Zoom app from your app store.

Step 4: To join a Zoom meeting, tap Join and enter the Meeting ID number.

Step 5: Allow camera and microphone access when prompted.

Step 6: You should see yourself and the other person on screen.

Step 7: Tap the red button to end the call when you are finished.

## Lesson 9: Using Maps and GPS

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Step 1: Open the Maps app (Apple Maps or Google Maps).

Step 2: Tap the search bar and type where you want to go.

Step 3: Select the correct address from the suggestions that appear.

Step 4: Tap 'Directions' to get step-by-step navigation.

Step 5: Choose driving, walking, or public transport.

Step 6: Tap 'Start' or 'Go' to begin turn-by-turn voice directions.

Step 7: The phone will tell you when to turn - keep it in a safe holder while driving.

## Lesson 10: Social Media Basics

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Step 1: Choose a platform - Facebook is popular for adults and family connections.

Step 2: Download the Facebook app and create an account with your email.

Step 3: Add a profile photo so friends and family can recognize you.

Step 4: Search for friends and family by name and send friend requests.

Step 5: Your News Feed shows posts from friends - scroll down to see more.

Step 6: To post something, tap 'What's on your mind?' and type or add a photo.

Step 7: Use reactions (like, love, etc.) to respond to posts from others.

# Lesson 11: Online Banking Safety

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Step 1: Only download your bank's official app from the app store.

Step 2: Never access banking through links in emails or text messages.

Step 3: Set up fingerprint or face recognition for secure login.

Step 4: Create a strong password with letters, numbers, and symbols.

Step 5: Enable notifications so you get alerts for every transaction.

Step 6: Always log out when you finish your banking session.

Step 7: Never do banking on public WiFi - use your home network or mobile data.

## Lesson 12: Setting Alarms and Reminders

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Step 1: Open the Clock app to set alarms for wake-up times.

Step 2: Tap the plus sign to create a new alarm and set the time.

Step 3: Choose which days the alarm should repeat (daily, weekdays, etc.).

Step 4: For reminders, use the Reminders app or say 'Hey Siri, remind me'.

Step 5: Set reminders for medications: 'Remind me to take pills at 8 AM'.

Step 6: Calendar events can also send you alerts before appointments.

Step 7: You can set multiple alarms and reminders for different needs.

## Lesson 13: Adjusting Text Size

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Step 1: Open Settings on your phone.

Step 2: On iPhone: tap Display & Brightness, then Text Size.

Step 3: On Android: tap Display, then Font size or Display size.

Step 4: Drag the slider to the right to make text larger.

Step 5: Preview the text as you adjust to find your comfortable size.

Step 6: You can also turn on Bold Text for easier reading.

Step 7: Some apps let you zoom in by pinching outward with two fingers.

# Lesson 14: Using Voice Commands

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Step 1: Activate your voice assistant: say 'Hey Siri' or 'Hey Google'.

Step 2: Speak clearly and naturally - no need for special language.

Step 3: Try: 'Call [name]' to make a hands-free phone call.

Step 4: Try: 'Send a text to [name] saying I will be there at 3'.

Step 5: Try: 'What is the weather today?' for a quick forecast.

Step 6: Try: 'Set a timer for 15 minutes' when cooking.

Step 7: Try: 'Navigate to [address]' for driving directions.



## Lesson 15: Saving Contacts

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Step 1: Open the Phone app and tap Contacts.

Step 2: Tap the plus (+) button to add a new contact.

Step 3: Type the person's first and last name.

Step 4: Add their phone number in the phone field.

Step 5: Optionally add their email address.

Step 6: Tap Save or Done to store the contact.

Step 7: Now you can call or text them by name instead of remembering numbers.

## Lesson 16: Sending Photos to Family

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Step 1: Open your Photos or Gallery app.

Step 2: Find the photo you want to share and tap on it.

Step 3: Tap the Share button (box with arrow on iPhone, three dots on Android).

Step 4: Choose how to send: Messages, Email, WhatsApp, or other apps.

Step 5: Select the person you want to send it to.

Step 6: Add a message if you want, then tap Send.

Step 7: You can select multiple photos to send at once by tapping Select first.

## Lesson 17: Using the Camera Well

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Step 1: Clean your camera lens with a soft cloth before taking photos.

Step 2: Hold your phone horizontally (sideways) for landscape photos.

Step 3: Tap the screen where you want the camera to focus.

Step 4: Make sure you have good lighting - face the light source.

Step 5: Use the zoom carefully - pinch outward gently, but avoid too much zoom.

Step 6: Try HDR mode for outdoor photos with bright sky and dark shadows.

Step 7: For videos, tap and hold the record button or switch to Video mode.

## Lesson 18: App Store Basics

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Step 1: Open the App Store (iPhone) or Play Store (Android).

Step 2: Browse categories like Health, Games, News, or Social.

Step 3: Read app descriptions and user reviews before downloading.

Step 4: Check that the app is free or note the price before installing.

Step 5: Look for the star rating - 4 stars and above is generally good.

Step 6: Be careful of apps that ask for too many permissions.

Step 7: To update apps, go to your profile in the store and tap Update All.

# Lesson 19: Staying Safe Online

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Step 1: Never share passwords with anyone, even people claiming to be support.

Step 2: Be suspicious of messages asking you to click links or verify accounts.

Step 3: Use different passwords for different accounts when possible.

Step 4: Keep your phone software up to date - updates include security fixes.

Step 5: Only download apps from the official App Store or Play Store.

Step 6: Be careful what personal information you share on social media.

Step 7: If something seems too good to be true, it probably is a scam.

## Lesson 20: Managing Storage

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Step 1: Check your storage: Settings > General > Storage (iPhone) or Storage (Android).

Step 2: Delete apps you no longer use by holding the icon and choosing Delete.

Step 3: Back up photos to the cloud (iCloud or Google Photos) then delete from phone.

Step 4: Clear browser data: go to your browser settings and clear cache.

Step 5: Delete old text message threads with large attachments.

Step 6: Remove downloaded music or videos you have already enjoyed.

Step 7: Restart your phone occasionally to free up temporary memory.

## Lesson 21: Using the Calendar

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Step 1: Open the Calendar app on your phone.

Step 2: Tap the plus (+) button to add a new event.

Step 3: Type the event name: 'Doctor appointment' or 'Lunch with Mary'.

Step 4: Set the date and time for the event.

Step 5: Add a reminder alert - choose 1 hour before or 1 day before.

Step 6: Add the location if helpful so you can get directions later.

Step 7: Your phone will notify you before each event so you never forget.

## Lesson 22: Emergency Features

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Step 1: Set up emergency contacts: Settings > Emergency SOS or Medical ID.

Step 2: Add your medical information (allergies, conditions, medications).

Step 3: Learn the emergency shortcut: press side button 5 times quickly (iPhone).

Step 4: On Android, press power button quickly 5 times for emergency call.

Step 5: Set up ICE (In Case of Emergency) contacts in your phone app.

Step 6: Learn to use the flashlight for emergencies (swipe up or check control center).

Step 7: Consider installing a medical alert app for additional safety.



## Lesson 23: Accessibility Settings

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Step 1: Open Settings and find Accessibility (it has a person icon).

Step 2: Turn on Larger Text to make everything easier to read.

Step 3: Enable Bold Text for clearer letters and numbers.

Step 4: Turn on Zoom for a magnifying glass you can use anywhere.

Step 5: Increase touch duration if you accidentally tap things.

Step 6: Turn on Spoken Content to have your phone read text aloud.

Step 7: Adjust display to reduce motion and avoid dizziness from animations.

## Lesson 24: Troubleshooting Common Issues

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Step 1: Phone frozen? Hold the power button for 10 seconds to force restart.

Step 2: No internet? Toggle WiFi off and on in Settings, or restart your router.

Step 3: App crashing? Close it completely and reopen, or delete and reinstall.

Step 4: Battery draining fast? Lower screen brightness and close unused apps.

Step 5: No sound? Check that the mute switch is off and volume is turned up.

Step 6: Screen too dark? Adjust brightness in Settings > Display.

Step 7: Still having issues? Restart your phone - this fixes most problems.

## Lesson 25: Quick Reference Card

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MAKE A CALL: Phone app > Keypad > Dial number > Green button

SEND A TEXT: Messages > Compose > Type name > Type message > Send

TAKE A PHOTO: Camera app > Point > Tap circle button

DOWNLOAD AN APP: App Store/Play Store > Search > Install

SET AN ALARM: Clock app > Plus (+) > Set time > Save

CHECK EMAIL: Mail/Gmail app > Tap inbox > Tap email to read

VIDEO CALL: FaceTime/Zoom > Select contact > Tap video icon